Structure of Matthew

Lake Gibson Fall 2026



Chapter 1 = Genesis

- “Genesis” of Jesus (1:1)
- Genealogy

Structure of Matthew

Chapter 1

Genesis

Chapter 2 = Exodus

- 2:15
- Herod kills male children 2 years old and under

Structure of Matthew

Chapter 1 Chapter 2

Genesis Exodus

Chapter 3 = Leviticus

- All about “righteousness,” “holiness,” and obeying God
- John calls all to repent
- “Be Holy for I am Holy”

Structure of Matthew

Chapter 1	Chapter 2	Chapter 3
Genesis	Exodus	Leviticus

Chapter 4 = Numbers

- Jesus is in the wilderness for 40 days
- Temptations
- Deuteronomy quoted

Structure of Matthew

Chapter 1	Chapter 2	Chapter 3	Chapter 4
Genesis	Exodus	Leviticus	Numbers

Chapter 5 = Deuteronomy

- Jesus goes up on a mountain and gives a new law
- Quotes Old Law (and Jewish leaders' interpretations)
- Authoritative, Mosaic figure

Structure of Matthew

Chapter 1	Chapter 2	Chapter 3	Chapter 4	Chapter 5
Genesis	Exodus	Leviticus	Numbers	Deuteronomy

Structure of Matthew

Chapters 5–28

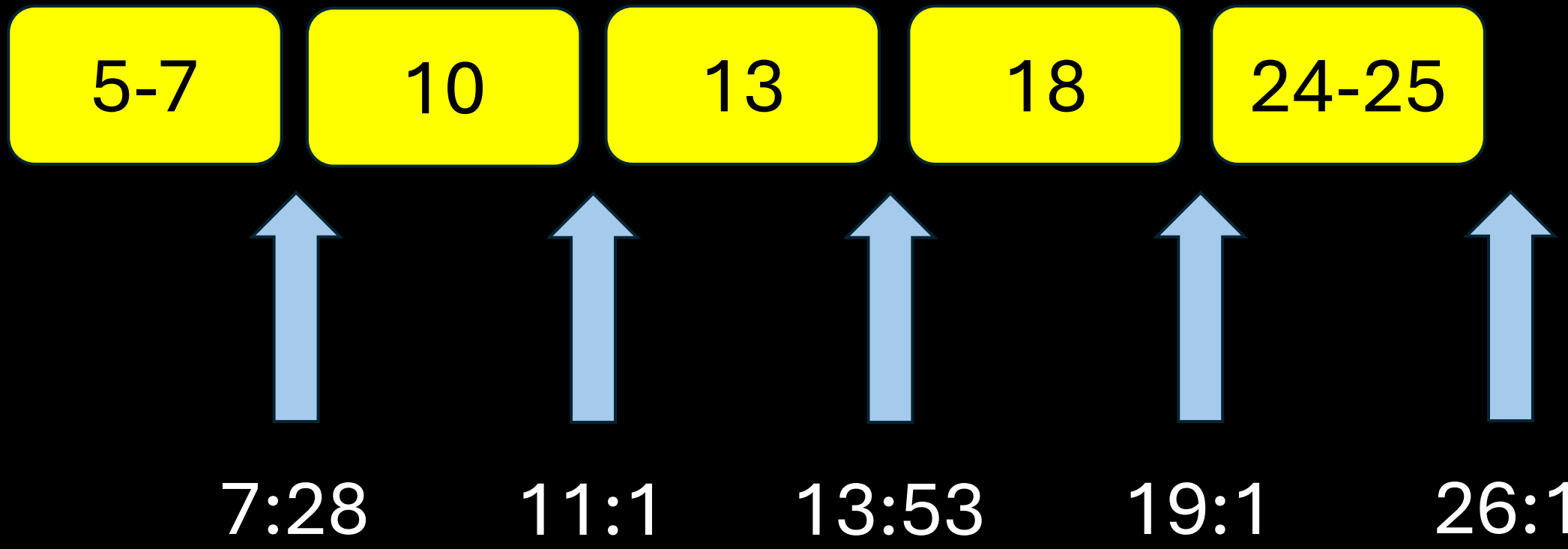
Deuteronomy
- 5 sermons of Moses

Matthew
- 5 sermons of Jesus

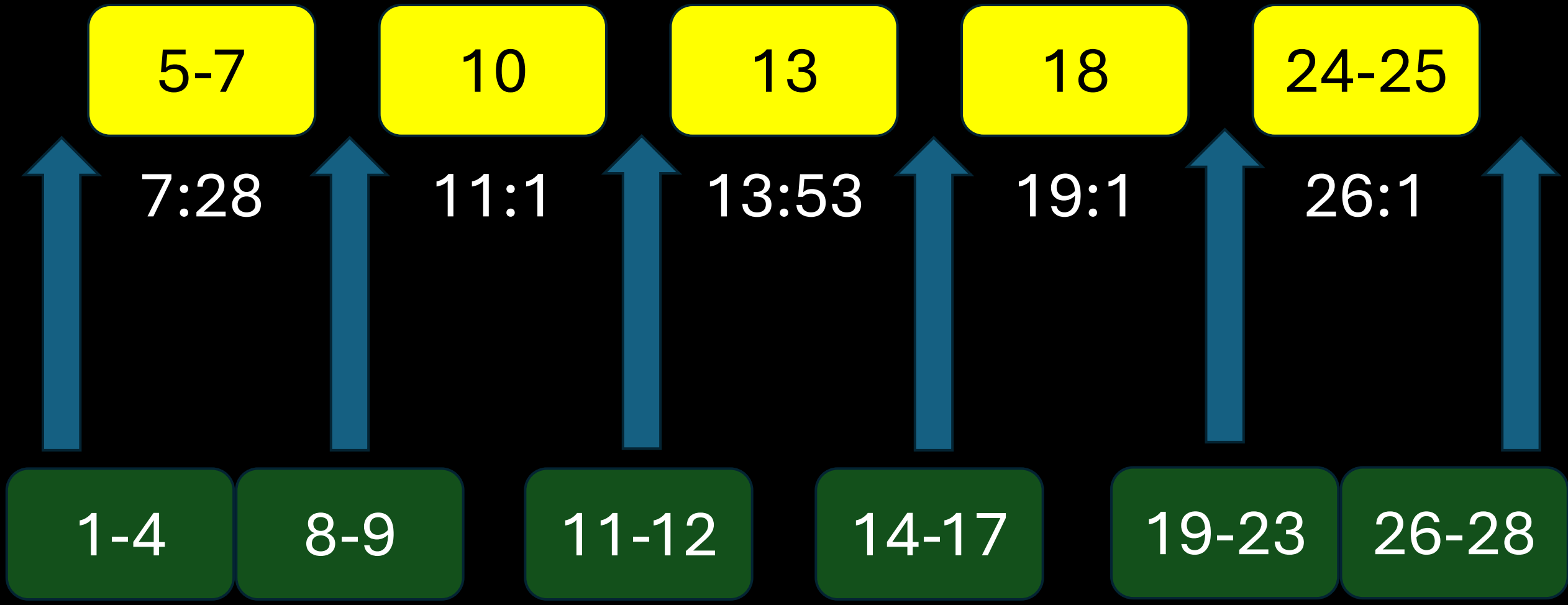
The New Moses

5-7	10	13	18	24-25

The New Moses



“When Jesus had finished…”


5-7
10
13
18
24-25
7:28
11:1
13:53
19:1
26:1
1-4
8-9
11-12
14-17
19-23
26-28
Jesus with the People

Structure of Matthew

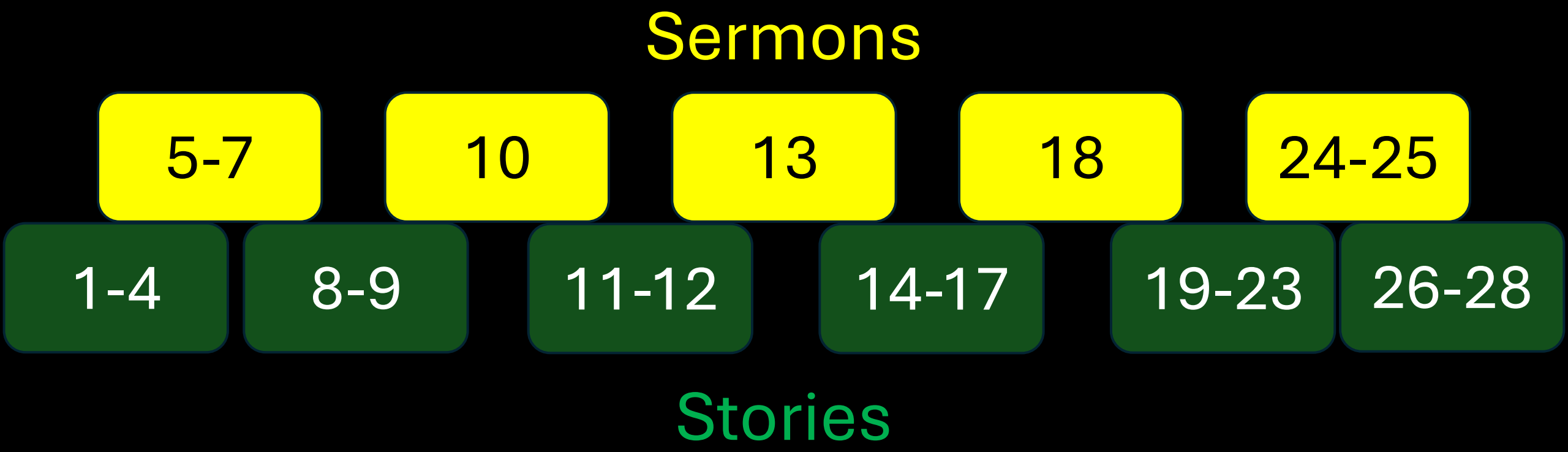
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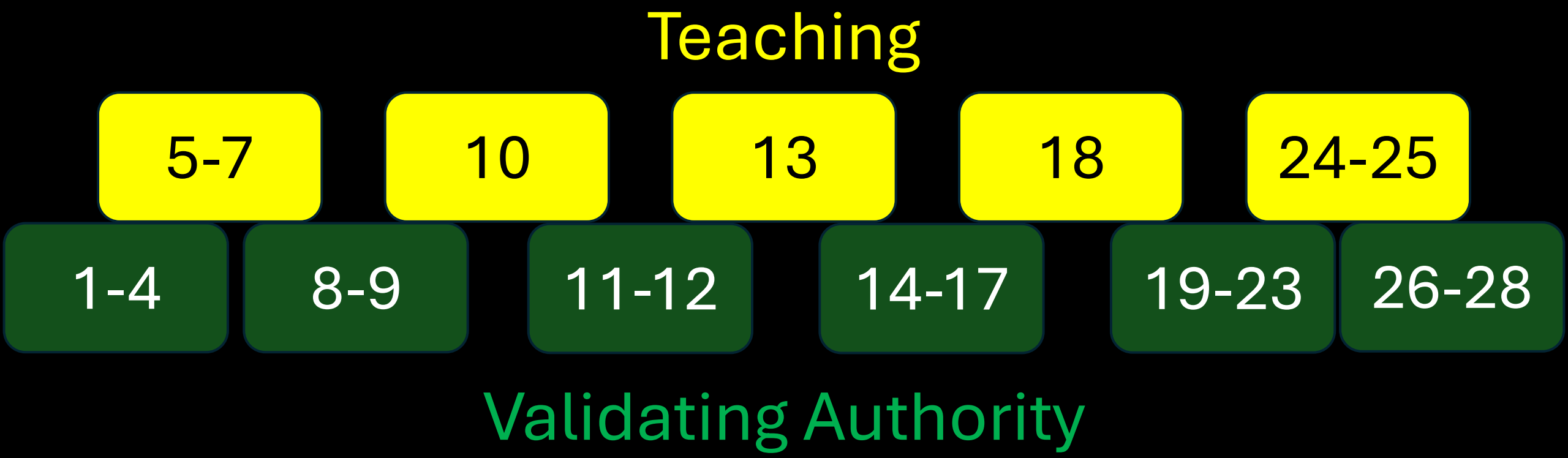
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Jesus with the People

Structure of Matthew



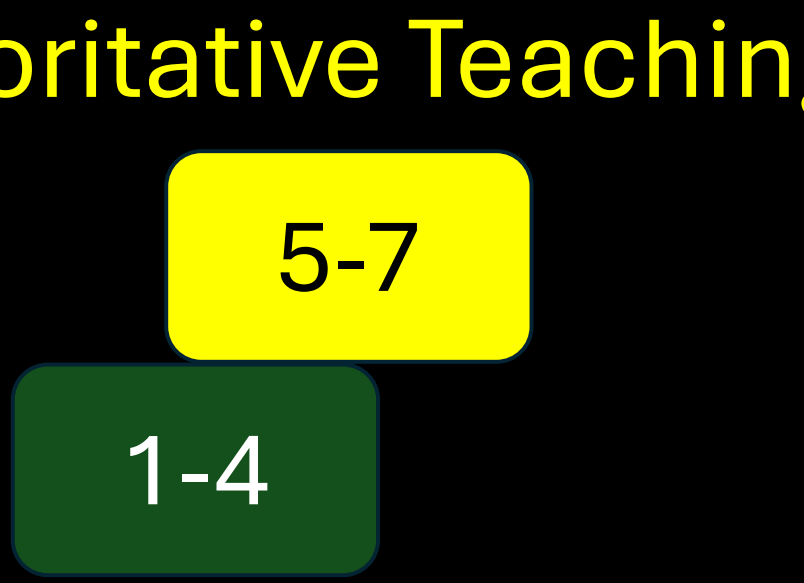
Structure of Matthew



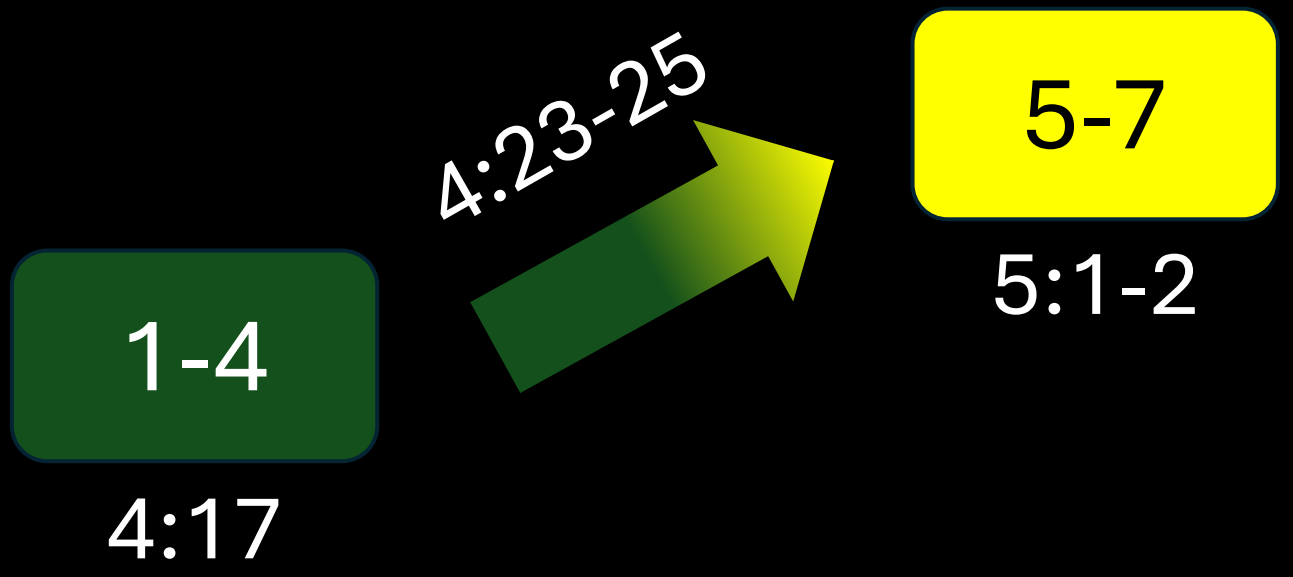
Structure of Matthew



Structure of Matthew



Structure of Matthew



Structure of Matthew

Adapted from R. France, *Matthew*, NICNT, p. 155

5-7

5:3-16: The distinctiveness of disciples
5:17-48: Kingdom righteousness
6:1-18: Piety, true and false
6:19-34: The priority of trust in God over material security
7:1-29: Judging, Golden Rule, Narrow Gate, Fruit, and Obedience

“[The Beatitudes] commends those whom the world in general would dismiss as losers and wimps… The beatitudes thus call on those who would be God’s people to stand out as different from those around them, and promise them that those who do so will not ultimately be the losers.”

R. France, *Matthew*, NICNT, p. 159.



As if He said, “Though they should call you sorcerers, deceivers, pestilent persons, or whatever else, blessed are ye”: so He speaks. What could be newer than these injunctions? wherein the very things which all others avoid, these He declares to be desirable; I mean, being poor, mourning, persecution, evil report. But yet He both affirmed this, and convinced not two, nor ten, nor twenty, nor an hundred, nor a thousand men, but the whole world. And hearing things so grievous and galling, so contrary to the accustomed ways of men, the multitudes “were astonished.” So great was the power of Him who spake.

However, lest thou shouldest think that the mere fact of being evil spoken of makes men blessed, He hath set two limitations; when it is for His sake, and when the things that are said are false: for without these, he who is evil spoken of, so far from being blessed, is miserable.

Then see the prize again: “Because your reward is great in heaven.” But thou, though thou hear not of a kingdom given in each one of the blessings, be not discouraged. For although He give different names to the rewards, yet He brings all into His kingdom. Thus, both when He saith, “they that mourn shall be comforted;” and, “they that show mercy shall obtain mercy;” and, “the pure in heart shall see God;” and, the peacemakers “shall be called the children of God;” nothing else but the Kingdom doth He shadow out by all these sayings. For such as enjoy these, shall surely attain unto that. Think not therefore that this reward is for the poor in spirit only, but for those also who hunger after righteousness, for the meek, and for all the rest without exception.

John Chrysostom, *Matthew*, 15.7, c. 390 AD

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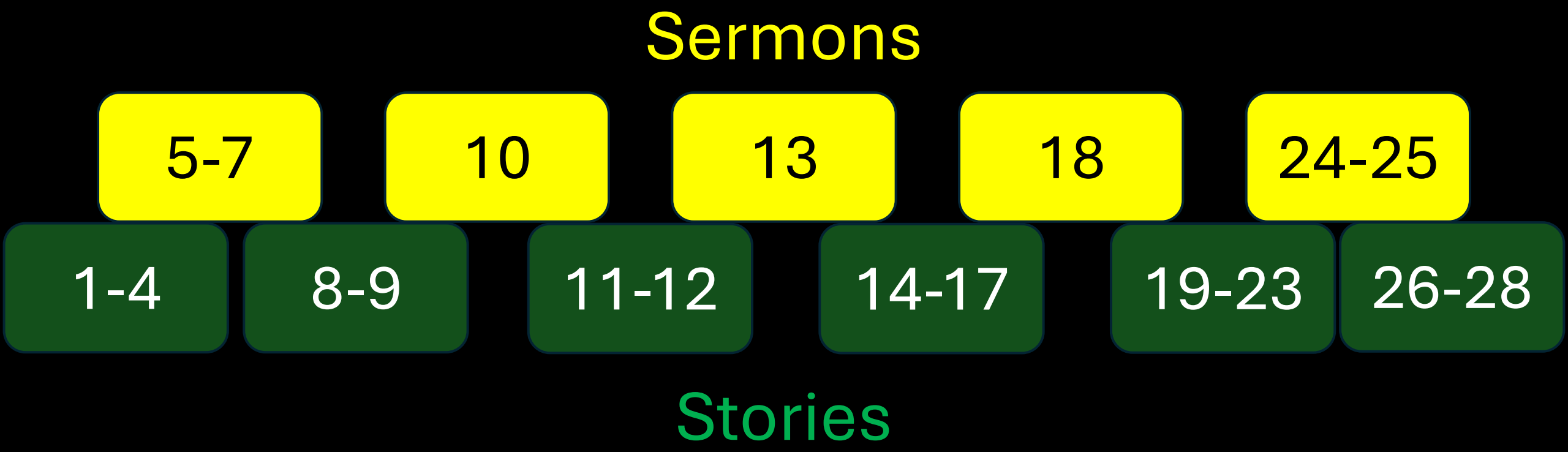
The New Moses

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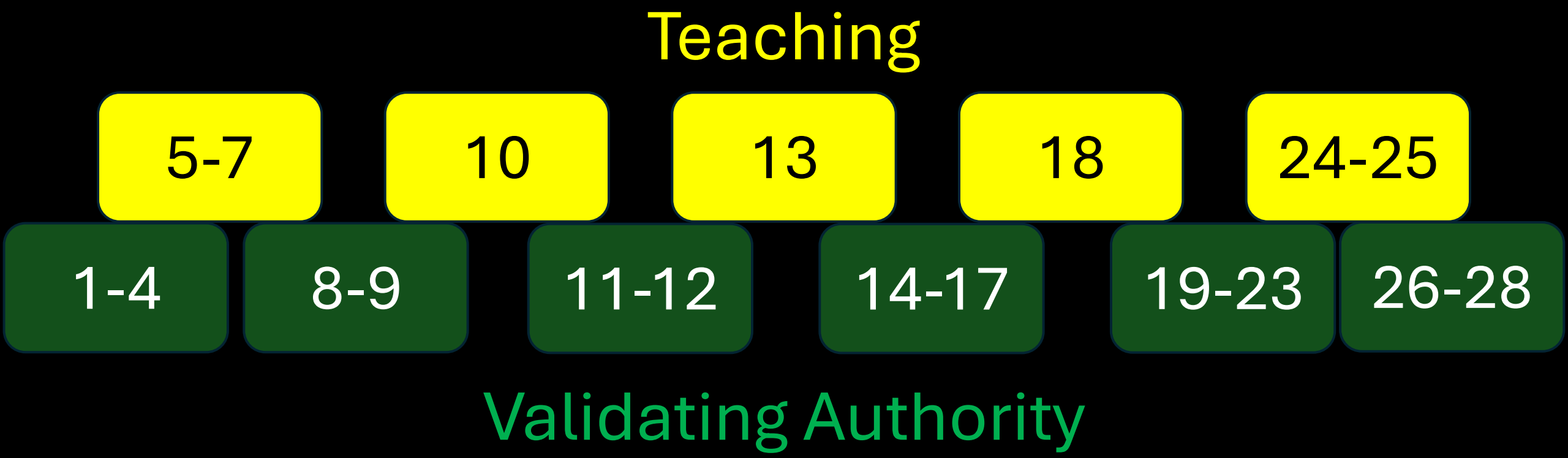
1-4	8-9	11-12	14-17	19-23	26-28

Jesus with the People

Structure of Matthew



Structure of Matthew



Structure of Matthew



Structure of Matthew

Authoritative Teachings

5-7

10

8-9

Authoritative Deeds

ARTICLE

Structure of Matthew

5-7

8:1

10

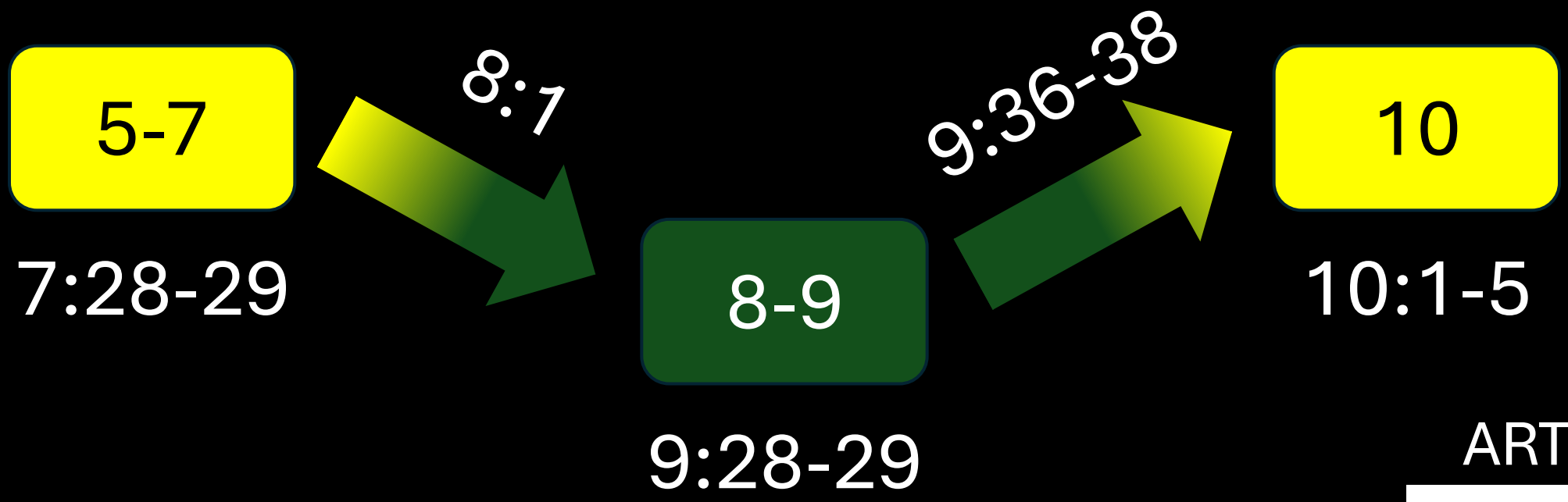
7:28-29

8-9

Healing
Belief
Disbelief
Authority

ARTICLE

Structure of Matthew



ARTICLE

Structure of Matthew



8-9

8:1-4

- Believing leper healed *by touch*
- Jesus is willing

8:5-13

- Believing (Gentile) centurion
- Authority
- Jesus heals *by word*

8-9

8:14-17

- Peter's mother-in-law healed *by touch*
- Crowds healed *by word*

"This was to fulfill what was spoken through Isaiah the prophet: 'HE HIMSELF TOOK OUR INFIRMITIES AND CARRIED AWAY OUR DISEASES.'"
(Matthew 8:17, NASB95)

“Allow the dead to bury their own dead”

1. Culturally, following Jesus instead of burying your father meant dishonoring him
2. An idiom meaning, “The matter in question is not the real issue”
3. “Let the spiritually dead bury the dead”
4. Literal and designed to shock hearers


Tyre
Chorazin
Gergesa
Tiberias
Nazareth
Gadara
Nain
Jerusalem
JUDEA
IDUMEA


Jordan
Chorazin
Capernaum
Bethsaida
Gennesaret
Cana
Gergesa
Tiberias
Hippos
GALILEE
Nazareth
Gadara
Nain
DECAPOLIS

Structure of Matthew

